

NAGA PULIGADDA

Principal Platform Engineer | AI/ML Infrastructure & Cloud Strategy | RHCA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Principal Platform Engineer with 15+ years orchestrating mission-critical systems for global fintech and media. Red Hat Certified Architect. AI/ML infrastructure specialist. I bridge the gap between reliability engineering and modern AI workloads.

Key Achievements:

- **300%** Platform scalability increase through global virtualization architecture (Mastercard Edge Platform)
- **50%** Reduction in platform downtime via advanced monitoring & alerting (200+ global endpoints)
- **90%** Decrease in deployment errors through automated CI/CD pipelines (API Gateway handling 5M+ requests/day)
- **\$100K+** Annual savings through observability-driven incident reduction (AppDynamics & Splunk)
- **2 weeks** → **1 day** Upgrade cycle reduction for mission-critical payment infrastructure
- **82%** Reduction in merge conflicts through smart branching strategy

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Mastercard | Pune, India / New York, NY

Lead Platforms Engineer / Principal Architect (DevOps & Edge) | Sep 2019 – Present

Strategic leadership of the Mastercard's Edge Platform, overseeing infrastructure for 200+ global payment gateways processing millions of transactions daily.

- Spearheaded migration of 200+ mission-critical Virtual MIPs from CentOS 7 to Oracle Linux 8 with zero data loss and 100% service continuity
- Architected physical-to-virtual conversion across 200+ global endpoints in under 2 months, increasing platform scalability by 300%

- Designed centralized Next-Gen Certificate Management System (NECMS) integrating Venafi and Ansible for mTLS automation under strict PCI compliance
- Reduced upgrade cycles from 2 weeks to 1 day and configuration time from 2 days to 30 minutes, cutting operational costs by 30%
- Improved platform performance by 20% through resource optimization, directly contributing to revenue increase
- Reduced platform downtime by 50% with advanced monitoring, resulting in 90% decrease in customer complaints

KK Software Associates — Mastercard | Various Locations

DevSecOps Consultant | Aug 2018 – Aug 2019

Led a team of 6 engineers deploying next-generation API Gateway infrastructure for Mastercard.

- Deployed NGINX Plus API Gateway handling 5 million+ concurrent requests/day
- Optimized XML Gateway efficiency, reducing policy deployment costs by 30% and errors by 90%
- Designed zero-downtime CI/CD pipelines using Chef Habitat and XL Release

KK Software Associates — Athene | Des Moines, Iowa

DevOps Architect | Jun 2018 – Dec 2018

Designed CI/CD infrastructure and release engineering strategy for financial services platform.

- Designed 20+ CI/CD pipelines using SaltStack and Python, reducing release cycles from 6 weeks to 2 weeks
- Saved \$75,000 per release through pipeline automation
- Engineered 'No-Conflict' branch strategy, reducing merge conflicts by 82%
- Automated database deployments via Flyway DB, reducing deployment time by 75%

KK Software Associates — Marvel | NYC, NY

Site Reliability Engineer | Jan 2018 – Jul 2018

Architected headless CMS infrastructure for Marvel's digital presence.

- Architected headless Drupal/MEAN stack on Rackspace, reducing time-to-market by 50% and TCO by 30%
- Automated infrastructure using Python and Ansible, improving reliability to 99.9%
- Reduced provisioning time for new environments by 75% with Ansible PaaS/CaaS integrations

KK Software Associates — IAC Applications | Yonkers, NY

DevSecOps Engineer | Jul 2017 – Dec 2017

Implemented enterprise-scale Identity & Access Management across large server fleet.

- Implemented Centrify IAM across 6,000 servers, reducing provisioning from 2 hours to 20 minutes
- Reduced security incidents by 50% and vulnerability remediation time by 75%
- Automated DirectControl AD joins and compliance audit reporting

KK Software Associates — Carnival Corporation | Seattle, WA

DevSecOps Consultant | Jan 2017 – Jun 2017

Led cloud migration and performance optimization for global cruise line infrastructure.

- Spearheaded AWS infrastructure with Akamai caching, delivering 50% performance boost and 30% cost savings
- Orchestrated Rackspace-to-AWS migration achieving 99.99% availability
- Implemented AppDynamics and Splunk, reducing MTTR by 15 minutes and saving \$100K annually

KK Software Associates — Wells Fargo Advisors | St Louis, MO

DevSecOps Engineer | Feb 2016 – Jan 2017

Designed hybrid cloud deployment blueprints for major financial services firm.

- Developed enterprise blueprints for hybrid cloud deployments using Puppet DSL, Vagrant, and Git
- Designed and implemented Anthill-Pro and UrbanCode Deploy pipelines for Java, .NET, and Unix
- Created custom migration scripts and RESTful APIs for Puppet Enterprise Node Classifier

The Walt Disney Company | Orlando, FL

Lead DevOps Engineer (via HCL America) | Mar 2015 – Jan 2016

Managed Configuration-as-a-Service for Disney Parks & Resorts infrastructure.

- Oversaw Configuration-as-a-Service for 5,000+ servers within Disney Parks & Resorts
- Developed Chef recipes with Test Kitchen, Foodcritic, and Rubocop for automated compliance testing
- Managed CI systems (Bamboo, Rundeck, Jenkins) for high-traffic guest-facing applications

Unilever (via HCL Technologies) | Bangalore, India

Lead DevOps Engineer | Sep 2012 – Feb 2015

Cloud migration and infrastructure automation for global consumer goods company.

- Migrated applications to AWS Elastic Beanstalk with high-availability auto-scaling groups
- Automated infrastructure operations using Perl scripts, resolving recurring issues permanently

Optum UHG (via Cognizant) | Plymouth, MN

Software Engineer | Sep 2009 – Aug 2012

Healthcare platform engineering focused on reliability and environment management.

- Reduced MTTR by 65% for Claims Processing batch jobs through new validation environments
- Achieved 100% on-time delivery and 99.9% uptime for critical batch jobs

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Strategic Leadership: Technical Strategy & Roadmapping, Digital Transformation, Cost Optimization (FinOps), Cross-Functional Mentorship, Engineering Culture Development

AI & Data Infrastructure: MLOps, RAG Pipelines, Vector Databases, LLM Orchestration, GPU Resource Management

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS, Azure, OpenShift, Docker/Podman, VMware, KVM

Automation & IaC: Ansible (Expert), Terraform, Puppet, Chef, SaltStack

CI/CD & DevOps: Jenkins, GitLab CI, UrbanCode Deploy, Maven, Artifactory

Observability: Splunk, AppDynamics, Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, CloudWatch

Security & Identity: Zero Trust (mTLS), Centrify, SELinux, Kerberos

Languages: Python, Shell Scripting, SQL, Groovy, Perl

EDUCATION

Post Graduate Diploma in Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning

International Institute of Information Technology, Hyderabad (IIIT-H) | 90% (Distinction)

Focus: Generative AI, Computer Vision, NLP, and RAG Architectures

Master of Science in Computer Information Systems

Grand Valley State University, MI

CERTIFICATIONS

Professional Certifications:

- Red Hat Certified Architect (RHCA) - Red Hat (Expired Jan 30, 2026)
- Red Hat Certified Engineer (RHCE) - Red Hat (Valid until Mar 25, 2028)
- Red Hat Certified System Administrator (RHCSA) - Red Hat (Valid until Mar 25, 2028)
- Red Hat Certified Specialist in Containers - Red Hat (Valid until Mar 25, 2028)
- Red Hat Certified Specialist in OpenShift Virtualization - Red Hat (Valid until Jan 21, 2028)
- Red Hat Certified Specialist in Developing Automation with Ansible Automation Platform - Red Hat (Valid until Mar 20, 2027)
- Red Hat Certified Specialist in OpenShift Automation and Integration - Red Hat (Valid until Mar 6, 2027)

Continuous Learning (2024-2025):

- Red Hat Training: 14 courses completed in OpenShift, Kubernetes, Ansible, and Virtualization
- AWS & Cloud: 7 specialized courses in AWS, containers, and Kubernetes (O'Reilly)

Legacy Certifications:

- Certified Chef Developer
 - IBM Certified Deployment Professional (UrbanCode Deploy)
 - Certified Akamai Web Performance Administrator
 - ITIL Foundation (IT Service Management)
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LEADERSHIP

Technical Strategy & Vision

Defined platform roadmaps for Mastercard's Edge Platform, aligning infrastructure investments with business growth targets and regulatory requirements across 200+ global endpoints.

Team Building & Mentorship

Led and mentored cross-functional engineering teams of 6–12 engineers across DevOps, SRE, and platform disciplines. Established engineering culture focused on ownership and continuous improvement.

Cost Optimization (FinOps)

Drove FinOps initiatives that reduced infrastructure costs by 30% across multiple engagements through right-sizing, automation, and cloud migration strategies.

AI-Ready Infrastructure

Bridging traditional reliability engineering with modern AI workloads — designing MLOps pipelines, RAG architectures, and GPU resource management systems for next-generation platforms.